THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

2024-25 Winter Term 2 UBC-V Individual TA Reports for ECON_V 601-001 - Microeconomics II (Bufang Duan)

Project Title: **2024-25 Winter Term 2 UBC-V TA SEI Surveys**

Course Audience: **17**
Responses Received: **6**
Response Ratio: **35%**

Report Comments

Recommended Minimum Response Rates

Class Size	Recommended Minimum Response Rates based on 80% confidence & ± 10% margin
< 10	75%
11 - 19	65%
20 - 34	55%
35 - 49	40%
50 - 74	35%
75 - 99	25%
100 - 149	20%
150 - 299	15%
300 - 499	10%
> 500	5%

Legend

N: Invited
n: Responded

Frequency Distribution
SD: Strongly Disagree

UBC Student Experience of Instruction

D: Disagree
N: Neutral
A: Agree
SA: Strongly Agree

Creation Date: **Tuesday, May 20, 2025**

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TA Questions

Question	N	n	SD	D	N	A	SA	N/A	IM	DI
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	17	6	0	0	0	0	6	0	5.0	0.0
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	17	6	0	0	0	1	5	0	4.9	0.1
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	17	6	0	0	0	0	6	0	5.0	0.0
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	17	6	0	0	0	1	5	0	4.9	0.1
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	17	6	0	0	0	0	6	0	5.0	0.0
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	17	6	0	0	0	1	5	0	4.9	0.1
The TA presented information clearly.	17	6	0	0	0	2	4	0	4.8	0.2
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	17	6	0	0	0	0	5	1	5.0	0.0
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	17	6	0	0	0	0	6	0	5.0	0.0
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	17	6	0	0	0	0	6	0	5.0	0.0
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	17	6	0	0	0	2	4	0	4.8	0.2
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	17	6	0	0	0	0	6	0	5.0	0.0
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	17	6	0	0	0	0	6	0	5.0	0.0
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	17	6	0	0	0	0	6	0	5.0	0.0

Question	%Favourable
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	100%
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	100%
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	100%
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	100%
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	100%
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	100%
The TA presented information clearly.	100%
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	100%
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	100%
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	100%
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	100%
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	100%
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	100%
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	100%

How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very Good	N/A	IM	DI
17	6	0	0	0	1	5	0	4.9	0.1

Question	%Favourable
How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?	100%

Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?

Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?		
Options	Count	Percentage
None	0	0%
Less than 25%	0	0%
25-50%	0	0%
51-75%	0	0%
Greater than 75%	6	100%

Which, if any, of the following did your Teaching Assistant do? (Please mark each element that is appropriate)

Options	Count
Led discussion-tutorial groups	6
Held office hours	6
marked examination(s)	6
marked essay(s)-assignment(s)	3
gave classroom lectures	0
conducted labs	0
responded to email	6
Respondent(s)	6

Considering everything, how would you rate this course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very good	N/A	IM	DI
17	6	0	0	1	0	5	0	4.9	0.3

Question	%Favourable
Considering everything, how would you rate this course?	83%

Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of your teaching assistant's (TA's) teaching, attitudes to students, class atmosphere, or any other matters affecting the quality of instruction that you consider worthy of note.

Comments
William is an incredible TA, and I would have had a far harder time in micro this year were it not for his teaching.
William is one of the most helpful people I know——or even believe can exist. Whenever I was struggling with the material he took extra time out of his week to help me work through the gaps in my understanding. He is a majority of the reason I have been able to do as well as I have (however well) in Microeconomics 1 and Microeconomics 2. He was always able to pinpoint precisely what I did not understand with ease——whenever you conveyed a problem to him he would first take time out to think through in the way you were and try to impute the troubles you may be facing in understanding. He is also extremely smart——and never once did I go to a session with him where I did not leave with all the answers I wanted. He is extremely articulate and also funny——kept class engaging always!
Sometimes I feel like the TA "freestyles" too much in tutorials, having to make corrections often, change notations, etc. Even though he shows complete mastery in the subject, I felt like these "freestyles" would harm the tutorial sessions a little bit. In any case, this is not a serious issue. It's just a detail.
TA always has great energy and show excitement (not overly excited, but more like good vibe) when talking about micro questions. The TA is also very responsive and helpful.

Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of the format and content of the course as they may have affected the teaching assistant's performance.

Comments
William Duan: what a phenomenal guy. His enthusiasm and kindness are infectious. I hope he keeps winning the TA award every year. I fear for batches that have to go through the core micro sequence without William.

Explanatory Note

The reported metrics are as follows:

1. Percent Favourable Rating

This is the percentage of respondents who responded with a 4 or 5 (Agree or Strongly Agree) on a scale of 1 to 5.

2. Interpolated Median

The data collected for Student Experience of Instruction (SEI) are ordinal in nature, with a natural order (from 1 to 5). The usual measure of central tendency for ordinal data is the median (50% percentile). The Interpolated Median (IM) is an adjusted median that considers the number of responses less than the median, greater than the median and equal to the median. As such, IM reflects the distribution of students' responses.

Consider the following example:

Frequency Distribution

Response for University Module Item	Section 1	Section 2
5 = Strongly agree	5	5
4 = Agree	3	5
3 = Neither agree nor disagree	6	0
2 = Disagree	1	2
1 = Strongly disagree	0	1
Mean	3.8	3.8
Median	4.0	4.0
Interpolated Median	3.7	4.2
Percent favourable rating	53%	77%

3. Dispersion Index

The dispersion Index is a measure of variability suitable for ordinal data (Rampichini, Grilli & Petrucci 2004). This dispersion index has values between zero and 1. A zero dispersion index indicates that all students in the section gave the same rating. An index value of 1.0 is obtained when the class splits evenly between the two extreme values (Strongly Disagree & Strongly Agree), a very rare occurrence. In SEI data at UBC, the index rarely exceeds 0.85, and mostly for evaluations not meeting the recommended minimum response rate.